

You likely do **not** need to study the entire textbook. The official DDE study material for **MBCP2003 – Human Resource Management** is organized into **five units**, which is the best clue for what the exam usually covers:

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Exam-focused 2-hour plan

Learn the 5 units, not the whole book

For a pass-oriented preparation, focus on definitions, functions, processes, and one example for each topic. Most distance-learning exams ask short notes, definitions, and descriptive answers from these units.

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The 5 Units (Most Important)

Unit I: HRM – An Overview

What HRM is, why it matters, HR department functions, and the shift from personnel administration to strategic HRM.



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Unit II: Human Resource Planning

Manpower planning, recruitment, selection, induction, and performance appraisal basics.



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Unit III: Training & Development

Training need, methods, development vs training, and evaluation.



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Unit IV: Compensation & Productivity

Wages, salary, incentives, benefits, and productivity improvement ideas.



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Unit V: Industrial Relations

Trade unions, collective bargaining, grievances, discipline, and dispute handling.

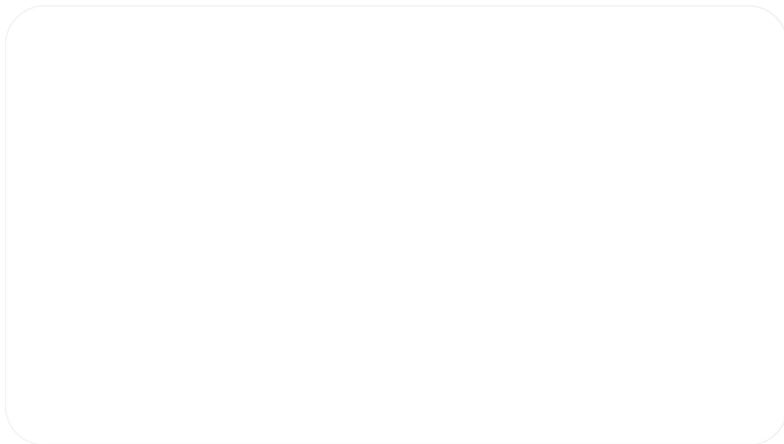


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2-Hour Crash Schedule

Time	What to study
0–20 min	Unit I: HRM overview
20–45 min	Unit II: HR planning, recruitment, selection
45–70 min	Unit III: Training & development
70–95 min	Unit IV: Compensation & productivity
95–115 min	Unit V: Industrial relations
115–120 min	Revise definitions & mnemonics

Unit I: HRM – An Overview (20 min)



Definition: HRM is the process of acquiring, developing, motivating, and maintaining employees so that organizational goals are achieved.

Functions of HRM

Planning manpower needs.

Recruitment and selection.

Training and development.

Compensation and benefits.

Performance appraisal.

Employee relations.

Remember

P Plan **R** Recruit **T** Train **C** Compensate **A** Appraise **R** Relate

Mnemonic: PRTCAR

Strategic HRM

HR decisions should support business goals such as growth, quality, innovation, and cost control. Modern HR is a **strategic partner**, not only an administrative department.

Exam-style answer (2 marks)

"HRM is the process of planning, recruiting, developing, compensating, and maintaining employees to achieve organizational objectives."

Unit II: Human Resource Planning (25 min)



Manpower Planning

Estimating future employee requirements and ensuring the right people are available at the right time.

Steps

Forecast manpower demand.

Forecast manpower supply.

Identify gaps.

Recruit or develop employees.

Monitor results.

Recruitment vs Selection

Recruitment	Attracting candidates.
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Selection	Choosing the best candidate.
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Selection Process

- Application screening.
- Tests.
- Interview.
- Reference check.
- Medical check (if required).
- Final offer.

Easy sequence

Recruit → Select → Induct → Appraise

Induction / Orientation

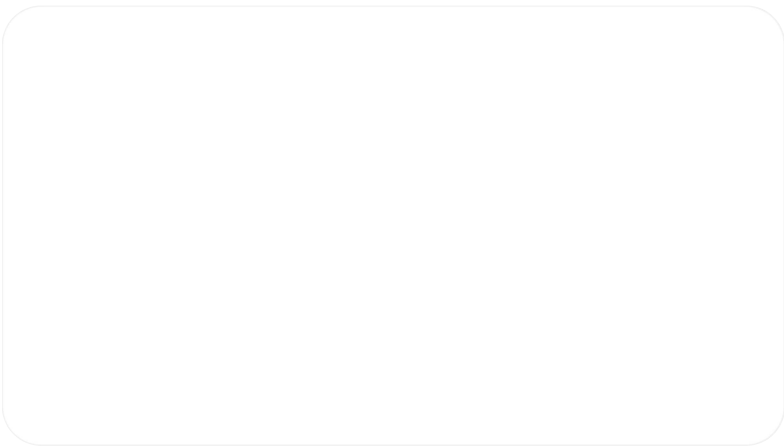
Introducing the new employee to the organization, policies, culture, and job responsibilities.

Performance Appraisal

Evaluating employee performance against standards; helps in promotions, training, rewards, and feedback.

 PDF +1

Unit III: Training & Development (25 min)



Difference

Training	Improves current job skills.
Development	Prepares employees for future responsibilities.

Training Cycle

- Identify training needs.
- Design program.

Deliver training.

Evaluate effectiveness.

Methods

On-the-job: coaching, job rotation, apprenticeship.

Off-the-job: lectures, workshops, case studies, simulations.

Why important?

- Increases productivity.
- Reduces errors.
- Improves morale.
- Supports career growth.

Exam tip

A common 10-mark question is "Explain training and development." Use **definition** → **need** → **methods** → **benefits** → **evaluation**.



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Unit IV: Compensation & Productivity (25 min)

Compensation

All financial and non-financial rewards given to employees.

Components

- Basic salary/wages.
- Allowances.
- Bonus/incentives.
- Benefits (PF, insurance, leave, etc.).

Objectives

- Attract talent.
- Retain employees.
- Motivate performance.
- Ensure fairness.

Productivity

Output produced per unit of input.

Simple formula

$$\text{Productivity} = \text{Output} / \text{Input}$$

Ways to Improve Productivity

- Training employees.
- Better technology.
- Motivation and incentives.
- Improved work methods.
- Safe working conditions.

Key distinction

Wages	Usually linked to hourly/daily work.
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Salary	Fixed monthly compensation.
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Unit V: Industrial Relations (20 min)

Industrial Relations (IR)

Relationship between employers, employees, and the government in the workplace.

Main Elements

- Trade unions.
- Collective bargaining.
- Grievance handling.
- Discipline.
- Industrial disputes.

Collective Bargaining

Negotiation between employer and employee representatives regarding wages, working conditions, and benefits.

Grievance Procedure

Employee complaint.

Supervisor review.

HR intervention.

Management decision.

Appeal/arbitration if needed.

Discipline Principles

- Clear rules.
- Consistency.
- Fair investigation.
- Opportunity to be heard.
- Proportionate punishment.

Quick recall

Union → Bargaining → Grievance → Discipline → Dispute

Likely Exam Questions

Very common prompts

Define HRM and explain its functions.

Explain manpower planning.

Differentiate recruitment and selection.

Describe the selection process.

Explain training and development.

What is performance appraisal? State its objectives.

Explain compensation and its components.

Define productivity and methods to improve it.

What is industrial relations?

Explain collective bargaining.

30-Minute Final Revision

Memorize the **five unit names**.

Memorize **HRM functions**: PRTCAR.

Memorize **Recruitment vs Selection**.

Memorize **Training cycle**: Need → Design → Deliver → Evaluate.

Memorize **Productivity** = Output/Input.

Memorize **Industrial relations elements**: Union, Bargaining, Grievance, Discipline, Dispute.

Best exam strategy Write structured answers

Definition

Need/Objectives

Process/Types

Advantages

Conclusion

Even if you remember only **4–5 points per question**, you can usually score decent marks in descriptive MBA distance-learning exams.